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**Universität
Oldenburg**

Fakultät II - Informatik,
Wirtschafts- und Rechts-
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**Department für
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VOLKSWIRTSCHAFTSLEHRE

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Recommendation Letter for Le Minh Hoàng

Dear Sir or Madam,

It is a great pleasure for me to write this letter of recommendation for Le Minh Hoàng, who is, since winter term of 2022, enrolled as a student in the master of science program *Applied Economics and Data Science* at *Carl von Ossietzky Universität Oldenburg*. In my role as both a lecturer and program manager, I had the pleasure of working with Mr. Hoàng in the “*Applied Economics*” module, where students conduct their own empirical research projects, and I know him from regular meetings and discussions as part of the mentor program. Additionally, I am currently the second supervisor for his master thesis.

Mr. Hoàng demonstrates a strong passion for advanced empirical research and continuously strives to refine his skillset. His seminar project aimed to empirically establish the relationship between water stress, land use, and electricity production. This seminar paper showcased his ability to work with geographical and remote-sensing data, as well as socio-economic data sets from various sources. He complemented these data by conducting insightful econometric analyses using *R* statistical programming language and spatial regression techniques.

In his master thesis, he is using geospatial data on the incidence of violent conflict to study empirically, whether World Bank foreign aid projects allocated to regions of increased water stress can be seen as a driver of riots, uprisings, and violence. Mr. Hoàng has mastered the computationally challenging task of data preparation thoroughly, with all steps being carefully documented in a Git repository. He is currently in the process of writing up the final results of the thesis.

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As for the supervision of his thesis, I enjoyed the constructive discussions of ideas for his thesis topic, in which Mr. Hoàng has shown his ability to defend his point of view in a professional and polite manner. I was impressed by his ability to deal with problems he encountered and critically reflect upon his prior work, always being ready to learn about new methods and techniques beyond the scope of the curriculum.

In addition, Mr. Hoàng is very diligent and plans his curriculum purposefully with high ambition. In the interaction with his peers and the teaching staff, I have observed him to be a helpful, reliable, polite, and eloquent student, who does not hesitate to provide assistance to his fellow students.

Accordingly, I was happy to hear that Mr. Hoàng is pursuing an academic career and applying for Ph.D. student positions. Given his strong programming and data analysis skills, coupled with his eagerness to learn and embrace new challenges, I am convinced that Mr. Hoàng will be a valuable asset to any institutes and of course a well-qualified Ph.D. candidate. I wish him the very best in his future pursuits.

Please contact me if you would like additional information.

Best regards,

A handwritten signature in blue ink, appearing to read 'Dannemann', with a stylized, flowing script.

Dr. Bernhard C. Dannemann